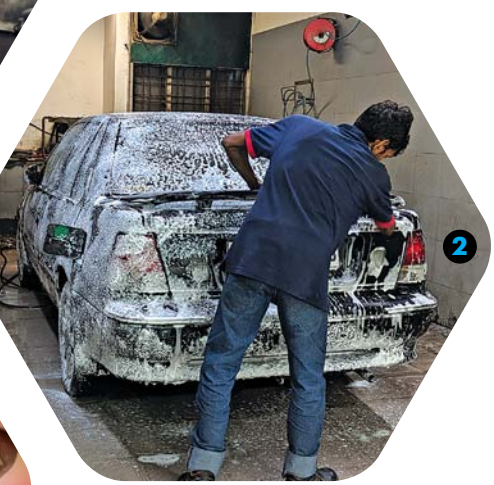






oil from providing the desired lubrication and can even lead to damage of the engine. In a worst case scenario, this can even lead to engine seizure. Check the engine oil level using the dip stick and make sure oil level is maintained up to the recommended level by the vehicle's manufacturer.

PAINT

Continuous exposure to sunlight can lead to slow fading of the paint work. Washing the car on a regular basis keeps dirt and corrosive elements at bay and reduces their effect on the car. Getting the car pressure washed is also a good idea as it forces dirt and grime out. Finally waxing, polishing and also a new age ceramic coating helps reduce paint fade. As far as possible, park the car in a shaded area.

TYRES

First check the tread depth and replace a worn tyre if the tread is found to be too worn. Avoid driving with under or over-inflated tyres. Temperatures also vary highly between day and night and that again has an impact on the tyre, with the rubber expanding and contracting, causing what is called 'dry rot'. This could lead to tyre walls cracking.

AIR FILTER

Dry weather and fast winds result in dust storms, especially in the northern part of the country. This has an impact on the way the engine breathes. The air filter's job is to keep the dust and grime out of the air that enters the engine and with dust storms a common thing, a choked air passage leads to a drop in fuel economy. The air filter also needs fairly regular maintenance if you drive on dirty and gravelly roads. The air filter is not an expensive replacement. If required, it must be changed immediately.

CARING FOR YOURSELF

It is also important to take care of yourself on the road. Start by ventilating the car before getting into it and switching on the AC. Most modern cars come with connected features and it is advisable to use them to switch on the AC and cool down the car. Needless to say, keep enough water in the car to hydrate yourself. Something as simple as sunshades work wonders in reducing fatigue. When you are driving for long periods of time in the scorching sun, your body loses a lot of essential salts and electrolytes through sweat. Be prepared for emergencies and keep packets of electrolytes in your first aid kit. ■